

Learning Objectives

Learners will be able to:

- Identify the different types of customers who will call the ITSD.
- Accurately describe the information gathered during each step of the ticket creation process.
- Give examples of probing questions.
- Engage support resources for assistance with troubleshooting or escalation.
- Escalate to an appropriate support group if no assistance is available.

Know Your Customer

Knowing the customer that you are talking to is the first step to diagnosing their issue accurately.

Determine the customer's ID, their equipment setup, and the environment they are working in to better diagnose the problem.

You cannot troubleshoot any issue effectively without determining these **first!**

- You may consider connection issues as a more probable cause if the customer is working from home rather than at a large campus.
- If the customer works in a virtual environment, how they connect to their workload will be different than a laptop user.
- Determine how the customer is connected to Progressive:
 - Working in office or working remote?
 - Home office or in the field(MRR)?
 - Mobile hotspot in use? Using VPN?
 - LAN cable, Wi-Fi or Cellular? Using a home private network or a public guest network?
- Is the customer with AFNI, Teleperformance or TTec? Troubleshooting may vary for each type, so make sure to verify this information as soon as possible when working with the customer.

For more information, refer to the following: [Job Aid – Know Your Customer](#).

Active Listening

Use active listening to understand the issue as described by the customer.

The issue may appear to the customer differently. What differences could exist between what the customer is saying and what is happening? The customer may give you insights into the actual issue by what they are telling you.

Think through the issue. Does the issue make sense? Has there ever been a time that a customer has told you about an issue that you know to be impossible? What was the solution?

Probing Questions

Ask relevant probing questions to clarify the problem. Examples include:

- When was the last time this worked?
- Has this ever worked before?
- Anyone else experiencing this issue?
- Is this the first time they've used the application?

Utilize Your Resources

Use available resources to better understand the issue.

- Search for knowledge articles using appropriate keywords.
 - Error messages provide perfect search keywords as they often are the title of the knowledge article.
 - **Application/Hardware** and **Symptom** also make for great knowledge search keywords.
- Remote into the system when instructed by a KBA or when specifically requested by a customer who is uncomfortable navigating on their own.
 - What are the advantages of seeing the issue?
 - What situations can be effectively resolved without remote assistance?
- Have the customer perform the function that produced the undesired effect. Have the customer replicate the error if possible.
 - The customer is often more familiar with the system in use.

- The exact steps performed that produced the error or undesired effect will be extremely useful for researching the problem.
- Grab screenshots of error messages to attach to the incident. Include URLs of affected websites, related incident numbers if relevant, etc.
- Your fellow team members may be able to provide clarity or recommend knowledge articles. Lean on TA support and knowledge to better assist your customer when possible. **Only** engage another ITSD tech if a support resource is unavailable.
- Check the customer's previous incident history to see if they have experienced the issue before. Look through the knowledge attached to that incident and review the steps from it that may resolve the issue.
 - When reviewing the knowledge attached to the incident, ensure the latest version of the article is being reviewed in case troubleshooting steps have changed since that previous incident.

Perform Basic Troubleshooting Steps

Reboot the affected machine. Power cycle the device if hardware issues occur. If relevant, perform browser troubleshooting: clearing cookies and cache, verifying compatibility mode, disabling active-x filtering and pop-up blocker settings, etc.

Escalation

If a KBA is identified that speaks directly to the issue, follow the KBA's escalation instructions to the appropriate support group.

Reach out to support resources via **BMC Live Chat** in SMART IT if:

- You are unsure that you are following a relevant knowledge article, or if another knowledge article could be relevant.
- You are unsure how to complete a step from the KBA.
- If issues remain and no escalation path can be found inside the KBA.

Ensure all basic troubleshooting steps have been performed, relevant knowledge articles have been applied, and no other relevant knowledge can be located before reaching out to support. The incident **must** be confirmed and saved **before** contacting support. The activity log **must** be saved so support resources can review it. Provide the support resource with your incident number.

Describe the customer's issue and why you are engaging support. Do **not** post your activity log. Document the support resources' name, their instructions, and the results of performing those actions with the customer in its own activity log.

If you are waiting for support resource to reply for more than five (5) minutes:

- You **must** continue to hold if the customer's issue is causing them to be unable to perform their primary job responsibility.
- You **must** continue to hold if the issue is affecting multiple users, as it could be the start of a potential outage or large-scale service interruption.

The Escalation team **must** be notified in these instances so the **Incident Management Team (IMT)** can be engaged, and any appropriate actions can be taken to minimize the potential downtime.

It's very important that the incident contains all relevant details, including affected applications, error messages, location details and accurate count of affected users to ensure upper tiers have all the necessary information to accurately diagnose and troubleshoot the core root of the widespread issue.

Incident Requirements

You will need to collect all relevant information when diagnosing any issue.

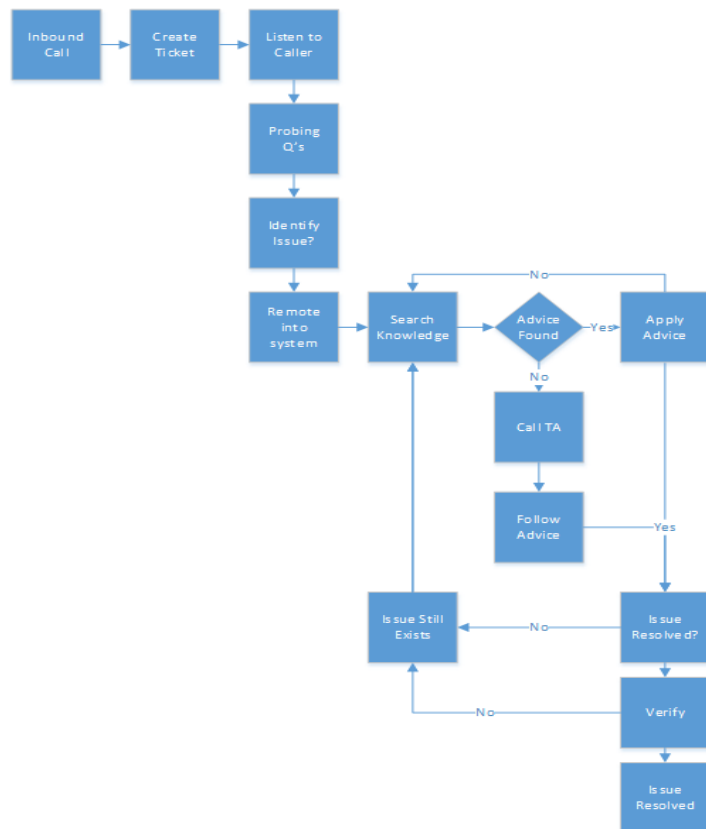
All Incidents Should Include:

- Callback Number.
 - Is there a cell phone number available?
- Machine name. Physical and/or Virtual when necessary for troubleshooting the customer's impacted application. If working in dual environments (physical/virtual machine), document both.
 - If the customer's issue is not experienced on their machine(s) and would be irrelevant to troubleshooting, you do not need to document the machine name(s).
 - There are some scenarios where gathering a machine name may not apply. When in doubt, document machine name(s).
- What type of machine is being used by the customer (all relevant).
 - Virtual

- Dell Mini/HP ProDesk
- Laptop
- How the customer is connecting to Progressive resources.
 - Working remotely or in office?
 - Using VPN?
- What is affected (HW/SW), and it's reported symptoms.
- Any other relevant information to the incident (policy numbers, model numbers, serial numbers, print servers, printer names, etc.).
 - Claims Incidents = claim numbers, draft numbers, etc.
 - Agent Incidents = agency codes, policy numbers, etc.

Escalated Incidents Should Include:

- Location details.
Campus/Building/Floor/Cubicle details if customer is based at a main office; City/State if customer is a remote user.
- Customer's work schedule.
- Indicate if user is HBA, Offshore Developer, or a CWS partner like AFNI, Teleperformance or TTec.



Transferring When Required

[KBA00271469: ETS – When to Transfer External Calls](#)

[KBA00271583: Claims – When to Transfer External Calls](#)